

OUR STORY

It began with one scientist looking closer.



Dr. Elaine Ingham at the microscope.

The Soil Food Web Foundation was established in October 2025 to carry forward the life's work of Dr. Elaine Ingham, the pioneering scientist whose research transformed our understanding of soil biology and its central role in food production, ecosystem health, and planetary regeneration.

She passed away in February 2026, and the work she started continues through the Foundation, the school that is a part of it, and Soil Food Web practitioners in more than 132 countries, who are helping to restore the world's soils.



Examine Dr. Ingham's publications here: sfw.one/publications

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CLIMATE

Soil carbon sequestration is widely recognized as a part of the solution to climate change impacts. Plants pull carbon from the air and invest much of it in the soil, where it is built into microbial bodies, aggregates and complex fungal networks. A biological approach to soil management reduces equipment emissions, reduces fertilizer and irrigation needs and creates more nutritious crops. Regenerating the world's soils using the Soil Food Web Approach can improve atmospheric carbon levels. Be part of the soil-ution!



Join our free online community

Learn from and connect with other passionate people in the regenerative agriculture space. You can also register for our newsletter and webinar series via the link in this QR code.

sfw.one/brochure-webinar

RESEARCH

The science is open, and anyone can test it.



Soil samples beside the microscope.

What biologically complete, properly-structured soil does



NUTRIENT CYCLING



CREATES SOIL STRUCTURE



INHIBITS WEED PRESSURE



REDUCES PESTS AND DISEASE



Testate amoeba, 40x objective. Photograph: Joy Kaluf. A microbial count names what is present in the sample and their relative numbers: bacteria, fungi, protozoa, nematodes and microarthropods.

What we test before we recommend remediation plans



Diagnostic first. Every recommendation starts with a biological analysis under a microscope.



Measurable. We provide a relative count of various microbes present in your soil or compost sample.



Adaptation and retrofitting. We help you convert your current operations to the soil food web approach, at any scale.

We train people who help farmers to transition away from using chemicals, to using biology. This results in significant benefits to the farmer and to the environment, as well as to the consumer. The method has been proven effective on 6 continents and across all soil types, as evidenced by our ever-increasing case study library.

PRACTICE

Growers are already implementing the soil food web approach, at every scale.



Agroecology plots at Rancho Cacachilas.

The basic methodology is universal; the application is based upon locally-sourced materials. Our case studies and field trials demonstrate the efficacy across a range of soil types at every scale from market gardens to massive industrial farming operations.

Nick Padwick farms four thousand acres in Norfolk, England. Roberto Silva works a hundred and forty in Piura, Peru. Jenn Sirp grows on a quarter acre in California. Check out their individual accounts of how the soil food web approach changed their operations through reducing inputs, creating better outputs and improving their bottom lines.

Though the projects run from backyard gardens to expansive public parks, the same process is applicable. The steps are the same at every scale: look at the biology under a microscope, add what is missing to rebalance the microbial content, then measure again to confirm microbial counts are going in the expected directions.

We partner with growers to teach them microscopy and biological compost creation and application so they can implement the approach where they farm, and document the impacts.



Watch the case studies

Growers filming their own soil, crop by crop and climate by climate. Start with one that looks like yours.

sfw.one/brochure-casestudies